

Speaking

What If...? History Discussion

Pairs · 8-10 min

In pairs, discuss two 'what if' scenarios about important moments in history or in your country, using the third conditional to imagine different results.

Useful language: If ... hadn't happened, ... would have ..., I think things could have been very different because ..., That's an interesting point, but what about ...?, I wonder what would have happened if ...

1. Choose one historical or well-known event you both know.
2. Individually, think of one way the event could have gone differently.
3. Take turns sharing your 'what if' idea using the third conditional.
4. Ask your partner at least two follow-up questions about their idea.
5. Together, agree on the most interesting 'what if' scenario and prepare to share it with the class.

My Biggest 'What If'

Groups of 3-4 · 10 min

Take turns sharing a personal regret or a 'what if' moment from your own life, using wish + past perfect and the third conditional, while the group listens and reacts.

Useful language: I wish I had/hadn't ..., If I had ..., my life would have been ..., That sounds like a tough decision., Do you think you'll ever get another chance?

1. Think privately of one small regret you feel comfortable sharing (school, sports, friendships, hobbies).
2. In your group, take turns sharing your regret using at least one target structure.
3. After each person speaks, the group asks one follow-up question.
4. As a group, decide whose 'what if' story was the most surprising.
5. Share your group's most surprising story with the whole class.

Writing

A Turning Point: What If It Had Been Different?

120-150 words

Write a short reflective paragraph about a real turning point in your life (or in the life of someone you know) and imagine how things could have been different, using the third conditional.

Plan:

1. Choose one real turning point (a decision, an event, a meeting).
2. Briefly describe what actually happened.
3. Write 2-3 third conditional sentences imagining a different result.
4. End with one sentence about how you feel about the real outcome now.

Checklist:

- ☐ I described a real event clearly.
- ☐ I used at least two correct third conditional sentences.
- ☐ I used topic vocabulary from this theme.
- ☐ My paragraph has a clear beginning, middle and end.

A Letter of Regret

100-130 words

Write a short informal letter or message to an old friend or family member, expressing one or two regrets using wish + past perfect and explaining what you would do differently now.

Plan:

1. Start with a friendly greeting.
2. Explain one thing you wish had been different, using wish + past perfect.
3. Explain briefly why you feel this way.
4. End with a positive or hopeful closing line.

Checklist:

- ☐ I used wish + past perfect at least twice, correctly.
- ☐ My letter has a greeting and a closing.
- ☐ I explained my feelings clearly.
- ☐ I checked my spelling and punctuation.